

incorporate Hadoop but don't possess the internal resources or expertise to do so. HaaS providers offer a range of support and features, from basic access to Hadoop software and virtual machines, from preconfigured software in a Do It Yourself environment to full service support options that include job monitoring and tuning support.

The importance and the reason of fame for HaaS is a no-brainer. The technology giants like Google, Amazon, Microsoft, IBM, Rackspace and Hewlett-Packard are all offering HaaS based solutions, in some way or the other. However, all the offerings are still very command line and MapReduce-focused, with the highest level of abstraction generally being a powerful programming language like Python. There might be chances of GUI-based Hadoop services, trying to take some of the responsibility of creating out the complex Hadoop jobs, coming up soon.

HaaS makes sense for similar reasons as running any other software offering on the cloud- quick, one time use cases involving big data computation. For instance, in 2007, the New York Times harnessed the power of Amazon HaaS for a single day to do a one time conversion of TIFF documents to PDF. This could have taken days, if done with the aid of traditional approach or a massive amount of fortune, if they were to setup the entire Hadoop systems and data centre on their own. The cloud, with its promise to access the hardware resources instantly, is very appealing to businesses who need to have a platform that scales fast to meet their growing needs. For instance, it would take several weeks to get a hundred more machines into a data centre whereas it would be available with a HaaS provider in minutes.

The businesses generally collect relevant data from various platforms and pass it to an analytics application running on Hadoop to extract insights from them. The load on the computational resources of a Hadoop cluster vary based on the rate of these incoming data or scheduled runs. A fixed capacity Hadoop cluster built on physical machines is always on whether

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